U.S. ARMY, VIETNAM — One of the Army badges that front-line soldiers wear with special pride is the Combat Infantryman Badge. It recently was awarded to Specialist Four Rodney J. Linn in Vietnam.

Spec. Linn, 20, son of Mr. and Mrs. Robert J. Linn, Route 1, Wakefield, also was awarded the Air Medal for combat aerial support of ground operations during the same ceremony.

He is assigned as a machine gunner with the 1st Cavalry Division (Airmobile).

The CIB has been awarded since late in World War II for sustained ground contact against an enemy.

In honor of its singular meaning, the badge is worn above all other awards and decorations, over the left breast. It is a blue rectangle with a silver rifle mounted on it, superimposed over a curved wreath. Subsequent awards are represented by stars at the top center of the wreath.

WITH THE COLORS

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